Ans. (c) : Grafting is a most common method of vegetative propagation. In this method, parts of two plants are joined in such a way that they grow as a one plant. Sweet orange plant is propagated by grafting technique. Layering is another type of vegetative propagation. In this method, roots are artificially induced on the stem branches before they are detached from the plant for propagation. Jasmine plant is propagated by this technique.

75. With reference to the evolution of living organisms, which one of the following sequences is correct?
(a) Octopus-Dolphin-Shark
(b) Pangolin-tortoise-Hawk
(c) Salamander-Python-Kangaroo
(d) Frog-Crab-Prawn

Ans. (c) : In the context of evolution of organisms, the correct sequence is Salamander (amphibian) - Python - (reptile) Kangaroo (mammals).

76. Consider the following:
1. Camphor 2. Chicory
3. Vanilla
Which of the above is/are plant product (s)?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (d) : Camphor is a waxy, flammable, white or transparent solid with a strong aromatic odour. Cinnamomum camphora is the source of camphor. Vanilla is a flavour obtained from the orchid of the genus Vanilla, generally from Mexican Vanilla planifolia. Chicory is a root extractor of Cichorium intybusis used commercially as a substitute for coffee.

77. In the context of alternative sources of energy, ethanol as a viable bio-fuel can be obtained from:
(a) Potato (b) Rice
(c) Sugarcane (d) Wheat

Ans. (c) : Sugarcane ethanol is an alcohol-based fuel produced by the fermentation of sugarcane juice and molasses. Because it is a clean, affordable and lowcarbon biofuel, sugarcane ethanol has emerged as a leading renewable fuel for the transportation sector.

ENVIRONMENT AND ECOLOGY

78. The Panda belongs to the same family as that of:
(a) Bear (b) Cat
(c) Dog (d) Rabbit

Ans. (a) : Panda and bear belongs to family Ursidae. Pandas are medium sized bears. Of all the endangered bear species they have the most distinguished colour combination.

79. In the context of Indian wild life, the flying fox is a
(a) Bat (b) Kite
(c) Stork (d) Vulture

Ans. (a) : Bats of the genus Pteropus are commonly known as the fruit bat or flying foxes among other colloquial names

80. Where is the headquarters of Animal welfare Board of India located?
(a) Ahmedabad (b) Chennai
(c) Hyderabad (d) Kolkata

Ans. (b) : The Animal Welfare Board of India was set up in 1962 with its headquarter at Chennai, under the provisions of the "Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act. 1960" (PCA Act. 1960).

CURRENT AFFAIRS

81. Which one of the following Union Ministries implements the Cartagena Protocol on Biosafety?
(a) Ministry of Science and Technology
(b) Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
(c) Ministry of Environment and Forests
(d) Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers

Ans. (c) : The Cartagena Protocol on Biosafety to the Convention on Biological Diversity is an international agreement which aims to ensure the safe handling, transport and use of living modified organisms (LMOs) resulting from modern biotechnology that may have adverse effects on biological diversity, taking also into account risks to human health. It was adopted on 29 January 2000 and entered into force on 11 September 2003. Ministry of Environment and Forest implements it in India.

82. In the context of CO_2 emission and Global Warming, what is the name of a market driven device under the UNFCC that allows developing countries to get funds/incentives from the developed countries to adopt better technologies that reduce greenhouse gas emissions?
(a) Carbon Footprint
(b) Carbon Credit Rating
(c) Clean Development Mechanism
(d) Emission Reduction Norm

Ans. (c) : The Clean Development Mechanism (CDM), defined in Article 12 of the Protocol, allows a country with an emission-reduction or emission-limitation commitment under the Kyoto Protocol (Annex B Party) to implement an emission-reduction project in developing countries.

83. The concept of carbon credit originated from which one of the following?
(a) Earth Summit, Rio de Janeiro
(b) Kyoto Protocol
(c) Montreal Protocol
(d) G-8 Summit, Heiligendamm

Ans. (b) : The Kyoto Protocol invented the concept of carbon emissions trading, whereby carbon credits were a "flexibility mechanism". Under this flexibility mechanism Annex 1 (developed countries) could use the carbon credits to meet their emission reduction commitments. A carbon credit is a generic term for any tradable certificate or permit representing the right to emit one tonne of carbon dioxide or the mass of another greenhouse gas with a carbon dioxide equivalent (CO_2) equivalent to one tonne of carbon dioxide.

84. With reference to the schemes launched by the Union Government, consider the following statements?
1. Ministry of Health and Family Welfare launched the Rashtriya Swasthya Bima Yojana.
2. Ministry of Textiles launched the Rajiv Gandhi Shilpi Swasthya Bima Yojana.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (b) : The National Health Insurance Scheme has been started by the Central Government from 1st April, 2008 for the families living below the poverty line. The central government will pay 75% of its premium, while the rest will be paid by the state governments. This scheme was started by the Ministry of Labor and Employment of the Central Government. Ministry of Textiles launched the Rajiv Gandhi Shilpi Swasthya Bima Yojana. Hence only 2nd statement is correct.

85. NAMA-11 group of countries frequently appears in the news in the context of the affairs of which one of the following?
(a) Nuclear Suppliers Group
(b) World Bank
(c) World Economic Forum
(d) World Trade Organization

Ans. (d) : NAMA-11 (Non Agricultural Market Access) is an organization of developing countries. In the Hong Kong Ministerial Conference of the World Trade Organization, 2005 presented by the European Union regarding tariff reduction(Non Agricultural Market Access - NAMA) on industrial imports of developing countries. The formula was accepted with modifications brought by Argentina, Brazil and India.

86. Recently, which one of the following was included in the UNESCO's World Heritage list?
(a) Dilwara Temple
(b) Kalka-Shimla Railway
(c) Bhiterkanika Mangrove Area
(d) Visakhapatnam to Araku Valley railway line

Ans. (b) : On July 8, 2008, the Kalka-Shimla Railway became part of the mountain railways of India World Heritage site.

87. In the latter half of the year 2008, which one of the following countries pulled out of Commonwealth of Independent States?
(a) Azerbaijan (b) Belarus
(c) Georgia (d) Kazakhstan

Ans. (c) : On August 18, 2008, Georgia's foreign minister announced the termination of its membership from the Commonwealth of Independent States.

88. With reference to the United Nations, consider the following statements:
1. The Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC) of UN consists of 24 member States.
2. It is elected by a 2/3rd majority of the General Assembly for a 3-year term.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (b) : The Economic and Social Council of the United Nations is a permanent body of 54 members, in which 1/3 of the members are released every year. Thus the term of each member is 3 years. But a retiring member can be re-elected immediately. Each member nation has only one representative in the council.

89. In the year 2008, which one of the following conducted a complex scientific experiment in which sub-atomic particles were accelerate to nearly the speed of light?
(a) European Space Agency
(b) European Organization for Nuclear Research
(c) International Atomic Energy Agency
(d) National Aeronautics and Space Administration

Ans. (b) : The European Organization for Nuclear Research conducted a complex scientific experiment in 2008, in which non-atomic particles can be accelerated to almost the speed of light

90. India recently landed its Moon Impact probe on the Moon. Among the following countries, which one landed such probe on the Moon earlier?
(a) Australia (b) Canada
(c) China (d) Japan

Ans. (d) : On November 14, 2008, on the birth anniversary of India's first Prime Minister Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru, the country's first fully India-built unmanned space craft 'Moon Impact Probe' (MIP) was landed on the surface of the Moon. M.I.P Separating from Chandrayaan-1, landed in a deep crater located on the South Pole of the Moon and made a presence of India's national flag tricolor. India became one of the countries after Soviet Russia, America and Japan who had brought their national flag to the moon with their own effort. On 1st March, 2009 China's change 1 executed a controlled crash onto the surface of the Moon. Hence correct answer should be and (d).